INTERVIEW SUMMARY — GEN Z & BRAND INSIGHTS

GEN Z INTERVIEW SUMMARY

Key Themes:

• Gen Z wants to influence what brands make but has no direct channel to do so.
• They feel many product drops “miss the mark” and don’t reflect their tastes.
• They struggle to trust sustainability messaging without proof or transparency.
• Trend inspiration is scattered across many platforms, making discovery chaotic.
• Their fashion decisions are shaped by mood, identity, and creators, not brands.

Representative Quotes:

• “I wish brands asked us what we liked before they made stuff, not after.”
• “Sometimes a drop feels like it came from people who don’t understand Gen Z at all.”
• “I see things online and think… no one my age would actually wear this.”
• “I’d trust sustainability if they showed receipts, not buzzwords.”
• “My inspiration is all over the place - TikTok, Pinterest, Insta- there’s no one place to put it.”

BRAND INTERVIEW SUMMARY

Key Themes:

• Brands design months ahead with very limited real-time youth insight.
• Their data sources are fragmented, with no unified source of consumer signals.
• They struggle to identify hype vs. lasting trend, making decisions risky.
• Feedback loops are slow and typically happen after launch, when changes are impossible.
• Sustainability choices feel directionless because they don’t know what Gen Z actually values.

Representative Quotes:

• “We make big design bets with very little visibility into what young consumers want.”
• “By the time we learn what Gen Z thought, the product is already out.”
• “Every team sees a different piece of the consumer; nothing is centralized.”
• “We can’t move as fast as trends are forming online.”
• “We want to be sustainable, but we don’t know which choices matter to them.”

CROSS-CUTTING INSIGHTS

• Both groups are making decisions with partial, fragmented information.
• Both want a way to connect earlier, before products are finalized.
• Both feel overwhelmed by the volume of platforms, trends, and signals.
• Both want authenticity and transparency, but neither feels they’re getting it.